Derek Misler

Senior Software Engineer

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Front-end engineer at Docker based in Arlington, VA. I build AI agent tooling and AI-powered developer tools, from design-system infrastructure to enterprise desktop workflows, using React, TypeScript, and accessibility-first practices. BFA, Graphic Design, Appalachian State University.

Skills

- **Architecture & Platform:** Front-End Architecture, Design Systems, Monorepo Architecture, Platform DX, API Design, Performance Optimization, Scalable UI Patterns
- **AI & Agent Systems:** AI Agent Development, LLM Integration, Agent Orchestration, Prompt Engineering, Agent Security & Guardrails, AI-Powered Developer Tools
- **Product & UX:** UI/UX Design, Responsive Design, Typography & Layout, Accessibility (WCAG), Interaction Design, Design Tokens, Visual Hierarchy
- **Quality & Delivery:** Developer Experience, Testing Strategy, CI/CD Workflows, Observability-Driven Iteration, Production Readiness

Experience

Senior Software Engineer, Docker Feb 2024 to Present

- Led engineering across Docker's AI agent platform and Docker Desktop admin experiences (including Gordon 2.0, Docker's AI assistant shipping to millions of Desktop users), establishing the team's performance optimization standards across the product surface.
- Built and rolled out docker-agent-action (Docker's AI-assisted PR review platform) across 100+ repositories and every engineering team; hardened its security posture, open-sourced it under Apache 2.0, and built self-serve onboarding so any team can adopt without manual setup.
- Embedded with Docker's AI Governance team as the sole frontend lead on one of the company's top priorities, supporting a major enterprise contract. Ramped on an unfamiliar codebase in days, took ownership of a stalled workstream, and moved the team from behind schedule to ahead of it.
- Rebuilt the shared Electron-based UI platform for Docker's agent tooling (monorepo, CI/CD, design system integration, hot reload, test infrastructure); the shadcn + Tailwind architectural decision made here resolved a company-wide component framework debate and was adopted as the standard across Docker's entire frontend codebase.

Senior Front-End Platform Engineer, Patreon Jan 2022 to Dec 2023

- Led the front-end workstream and partnered with backend platform + infrastructure teams, delivering an immediate 55% reduction in LCP (primary KR metric).
- Designed an incremental migration pattern to move features safely without blocking product delivery, enabling staged rollout and parallel work.
- Built rollout and reliability guardrails: percentage-based feature flags, alerting/triage workflows, and dashboards to monitor regressions.

Senior Engineer, then Tech Lead, Cadre Mar 2020 to Jan 2022

- Led internal design system built on Base Web component library (open-source contributor).
- Unified decoupled SPA and third-party marketing site into cohesive Django/React app; migrated front-end to monorepo.

Staff Front-End/Mobile Engineer, Transfix Jan 2016 to Mar 2020

- First front-end engineer; established web and mobile architecture, rebuilding Android/iOS apps in React Native.
- Implemented CI/CD with CircleCI, defined linting/testing standards, and led creation of internal component library.

Web Manager, Developer, Photographer, Asheville Convention & Visitors Bureau Dec 2010 to Dec 2015